

Meta Ads: Step-by-Step Client Tutorial

From day one with a client to a scaling account. Each step lists what to build, which settings to use, and what to check before moving on.

0
Numbers
AOV, break-even

1 Setup
pixel, columns

2
Creatives
audit or make

3
Creative test
campaign #1

4 Pick winners
KPI checks

5 Copy + page
campaigns #2-3

6
Troubleshoot
funnel tree

7 Launch
campaigns #4-6

8 Scale
+ weekly loop

0-1 Before any campaign: numbers and setup

0 • Business numbers (use the one-pager)

- **AOV**, costs per order → **margin**
- **Break-even CPA** = margin · **Break-even ROAS** = AOV ÷ margin
- **Target CPA / ROAS** (≈ 1.5× break-even ROAS) and goal: profit or growth
- **Daily budget** → ads you can support (~\$30 = 1-3 ads)

1 • Account setup

- ☐ Pixel on the site = dataset selected in Ads Manager (check with Meta Pixel Helper); Purchase event fires with value
- ☐ Save the column preset: CTR (all), link CTR, CPM, CPC, content views, adds to cart, checkouts, purchases, ROAS, 3s plays
- ☐ Build custom audiences: 50% video viewers, IG/FB engagers, site visitors, add to cart, purchasers
- ☐ Note funnel baseline in Shopify and walk checkout on a phone

2 Get the creatives to test

Existing account → mine what you already paid for

- Ads Manager → **Ad level**, last 6-12 months, sort by **amount spent** (not ROAS)
- Keep ads with meaningful spend (\$300-1,000+) near target CPA
- Add "shadow" ads: low spend but strong link CTR or cheap CPM
- Shortlist **8-15** → they go into campaign #1
- For each winner note: format, idea, hook, selling point → this is your next brief

New account → make 5-15 from customer evidence

- Read reviews, comments, tickets, Reddit, competitor reviews: **what they want, what stops them, what they've tried**
- One problem = one angle = one sentence per ad
- Show every claim visually; real phone footage beats polish
- Mix formats: e.g. 2 static, 3 UGC, 2 carousel, 2 demo/infographic
- Fewer ads if budget is small (see step 3 maths)

3 Campaign #1: Creative Test (CT)

CT • Creative test

goal: find the 2-5 ads with the cheapest attention that also sell

Campaign	Buying type Auction · Objective Sales · Advantage+ catalog off · Campaign budget (CBO) \$30/day+ · ignore campaign score
Ad set	Audience broad (no interests/age/gender unless product is gender-specific) · Acquire new customers · Conversion location Website · Maximise number of conversions · Event Purchase · Attribution 7-day click / 1-day view · Dynamic creative off · placements default · no end date
Ads	Your 5-15 shortlisted ads · URL = homepage for now (tested later) · one headline + text each
Rule	Select only these ads → More → Create rule → Turn off ads when impressions > 1,000 · schedule Continuously (800 on a new pixel with \$50-70 CPM, 2-3k if budget allows)
How long	Days = ads × CPM × (cap ÷ 1,000) ÷ daily budget → e.g. 8 ads × \$30 × 1 ÷ \$30 = 8 days . Too long? Test fewer ads.

4 Pick the winners: the KPI checks, in order



5 Campaigns #2 and #3: package and destination

#2 Copy test	only if link CTR < ½ of CTR	#3 Landing page test	often the biggest win
Campaign	Sales · ad-set budget (ABO)	Campaign	Sales · ABO , equal budget per ad set
Ad sets	3-5, broad, ~\$15/day each, same #1 ad	Ad sets	One per URL, same ad + winning copy , broad
Variable	Primary text only: original · short · long · emoji · review first · emotional	Variable	Homepage · collection · product page · custom persona page
Stop	~\$200 total → keep copy with the smallest CTR → link CTR gap	Stop	~\$100 each → keep URL with most carts reaching purchase (one case: homepage 0x vs product 3.7x)

6 Troubleshoot: nothing fully healthy? Walk the funnel top-down

Fix only the **first** "no", then re-check. More budget or new ads won't fix a leak further down.

1 CTR (all) ≥ 2%?	no →	Ad doesn't stop the scroll	→	New hook / first frame; lead with the customer's problem; retest in CT
2 Link CTR ≥ ½ CTR?	no →	Attention, no intent	→	Copy test (#2); clearer benefit, offer and CTA; show what they're buying
3 Page views ≈ link clicks?	no →	People never see the page	→	Page speed, mobile layout, pixel/tracking, accidental clicks
4 Add to cart ≥ 10%?	no →	Page doesn't continue the ad	→	Landing page test (#3); match ad promise; reviews + in-use photos; bolder CTA; check price
5 Cart → checkout ≥ 50%?	no →	Friction in the cart	→	Show shipping early / free-shipping threshold; remove upsell clutter; checkout button visible on mobile
6 Checkout → purchase ≥ 50%?	no →	Last-step doubt	→	Payment options, trust badges, delivery times; bottom retargeting with reviews or 5% off for 24h
7 CPA ≤ target?	no →	Numbers don't work	→	Raise AOV first: bundle, quantity break (2 for -5%, 3 for -10%), add-on at checkout

All "yes" → go to step 7 ↓

7 Launch the main account: campaigns #4-6

#4 Interest test

one audience per ad set

Campaign	Sales · ABO · name ad sets after the interest
Ad sets	\$10-20/day each · Audience → "Further limit reach" → one interest only (never stack untested ones) · winning ads + copy + URL
Pick interests	What buyers <i>do</i> , not the obvious category: e.g. matcha, yoga and Whole Foods beat Lululemon/Nike; blackout blinds → infant, diaper, trucking
Next	Cut interests that don't convert in 2-3 days · stack interests that won alone into one bigger ad set

#5 ASC "Winning assets"

main engine

Campaign	Sales · Advantage+ (default audience) · ~80-90% of budget together with #4
Ads	3-4 winners from CT, winning copy, winning URL. Nothing untested.
Why	Meta finds buyers; you control what it shows

#6 Retargeting (RT)

10-20% of budget

Campaign	Sales · CBO · 2 ad sets (optional minimum spend on bottom)
Middle	50% video viewers of winning ads + IG/FB engagers 365d · exclude site visitors 180d, buyers 730d · ads #4-5: education, pain, testimonials · judge on clicks
Bottom	Add to cart + visitors 180d, buyers 180d · exclude buyers 30d · ads #6-8: reviews, unboxing, 5% off 24h · judge on sales

The account once it's live

Prospecting · 80-90%

#5 ASC winning assets + #4 winning interests

Retargeting · 10-20%

#6 middle → bottom

Side test (always separate)

New creative batch in a fresh CT.
Only ads that beat the current winners move into #5.

Optional later

\$10/day engagement on winning sales ads (social proof) · catalog ads for multi-product stores · Instagram-only or women-only test from breakdowns

8 Scale and keep it healthy

How to grow

- ROAS above target? Add **\$10-20/day** at a time. Never jump a 16x ad to \$150/day.
- Use new budget for a **new audience** or a **new creative test**
- Branch winners one change at a time: new hook · creator · format · offer · message · angle
- Swings around **\$500-700/day**? Add a **persona bucket** with its own ads, page and numbers (e.g. hunters vs compression-sock buyers), or go broader with mass-appeal creative
- Don't chase an 8x target when 3-5x is well above break-even

Weekly loop (every client)

- ☐ Pull last 7 days: CTR, link CTR, CPM, carts, checkouts, purchases, CPA
- ☐ Run the step 6 tree; fix only the first "no"
- ☐ Turn off ads with meaningful spend above target CPA
- ☐ Fatigue check on winners: frequency and CPM up, CTR down → brief variations
- ☐ Log what was tested and what won → next creative brief
- ☐ Budget decision: scale, hold, or fix

Built from 5 Sergio C (ADVT Media) videos, Sep 2026. Budget figures (\$15, \$100, \$10-20) are the amounts he used as examples; adapt them to the client's budget. "Target ≈ 1.5x break-even" is derived from his worked example.